THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE · Nursery – Class XII · Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur · 9887258679

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME — SOCIAL SCIENCE · CLASS 9 · SET 04

Max. Marks: 80 · The Mastermind Coaching Classes, Jaipur · Alternate correct methods to be given full credit

SECTION A — Multiple Choice Questions — 20 questions · 20 marks

Select the most appropriate option. (20 × 1 = 20)

1. Ocean waves are primarily caused by:

(a) the rotation of the Moon
(b) volcanic eruptions on land
(c) winds blowing across the water surface
(d) river discharge

> **Ans: (c)** Waves carry energy across oceans; tsunamis are caused by underwater earthquakes.

2. The word ‘economics’ comes from the Greek word oikonomia, which means:

(a) household management
(b) market place
(c) trade of goods
(d) taxation

> **Ans: (a)** Oikos = household; nemein = management.

3. Tropical rainforests are called a ‘gene bank’ because they:

(a) receive no rainfall
(b) have no tall trees
(c) are found only in India
(d) preserve the unique genetic material of a huge variety of species

> **Ans: (d)** Rich biodiversity supports conservation and research.

4. Pāṭaliputra was the capital of the Mauryan Empire and also of the:

(a) Chola Empire
(b) Gupta Empire
(c) Vijayanagara Empire
(d) Delhi Sultanate

> **Ans: (b)** Present-day Patna.

5. The Sengol, a symbol of just rulership, was placed in India's new Parliament building in the year:

(a) 1947 (b) 2023 (c) 1950 (d) 2005

> **Ans: (b)** Linked to the Chola tradition and the transfer of power in 1947.

6. Election symbols are allotted to political parties by the:

(a) Supreme Court
(b) President of India
(c) Election Commission of India
(d) Speaker of the Lok Sabha

> **Ans: (c)** ECI registers parties and allots symbols.

7. Under the iqta system of the Delhi Sultanate:

(a) territories were assigned to military commanders in lieu of salary
(b) land was given free to all farmers
(c) temples collected revenue
(d) villages elected their own rulers

> **Ans: (a)** A mechanism of revenue collection that increased the peasants' burden.

8. The ‘liquidity’ of an asset refers to:

(a) the profit it earns
(b) the tax paid on it
(c) the risk of losing it

(d) how quickly it can be converted into cash without losing value

> **Ans: (d)** Cash is the most liquid asset.

9. Which of the following is NOT an element of weather and climate?

(a) Temperature (b) Atmospheric pressure

(c) Humidity (d) Soil fertility

> **Ans: (d)** Elements: temperature, humidity, precipitation, pressure, wind.

10. The Government of India's flagship programme to support new businesses and promote Atmanirbhar Bharat is:

(a) Make Over India (b) Startup India

(c) Digital Savings Mission (d) Rural Roads Scheme

> **Ans: (b)** Supports innovation-driven ventures.

11. At the Union level, India follows a _____ form of democracy.

(a) direct (b) presidential

(c) parliamentary representative (d) one-party

> **Ans: (c)** People elect representatives; the Council of Ministers is answerable to the Lok Sabha.

12. In the Buddhist Saṁghas, decisions were generally taken through:

(a) discussion and voting (b) decree of the head

(c) inheritance (d) drawing lots always

> **Ans: (a)** An early example of democratic procedures.

13. Read the statements and choose the correct option.
Statement 1: Cuneiform and Egyptian hieroglyphs have been deciphered by scholars.
Statement 2: The Harappan script has been fully deciphered.

(a) Both statements are correct

(b) Statement 1 is correct, Statement 2 is incorrect

(c) Statement 1 is incorrect, Statement 2 is correct

(d) Both statements are incorrect

> **Ans: (b)** The Harappan script remains undeciphered.

14. 'Rājadharma' in Indian tradition refers to:

(a) a tax on trade

(b) the foremost duty of an ideal ruler to protect people and uphold dharma

(c) a dynasty of Gujarat

(d) a Buddhist council

> **Ans: (b)** Governance was seen as a sacred responsibility.

15. Match Column I with Column II and choose the correct option.

Column I	Column II
(a) Nāikī Devī	1. Established the Akāl Takht
(b) Gokul	2. Defeated Muhammad Ghūrī at Kasahrada (1178)
(c) Guru Hargobind	3. Led the Jat revolt of 1669

(a) a-2, b-3, c-1 (b) a-1, b-3, c-2 (c) a-3, b-1, c-2 (d) a-2, b-1, c-3

> **Ans: (a)** Nāikī Devī – Kasahrada; Gokul Jat – 1669; Guru Hargobind – Akāl Takht.

16. A bowl-shaped hollow cut by a glacier at the head of a mountain valley is a:

(a) fjord (b) barchan (c) delta (d) cirque

Ans: (d) Erosional glacial landform.

17. Under progressive taxation:

(a) the tax payable rises as income increases
(b) everyone pays the same amount
(c) only the poor pay tax
(d) tax falls with income

Ans: (a) India follows a slab system.

18. Market supply of a good at a given price is obtained by:

(a) subtracting costs from revenue
(b) multiplying price with demand
(c) adding the quantities supplied by all sellers at that price
(d) taking the largest seller's supply

Ans: (c) Same logic as market demand.

19. A deep, narrow valley with steep sides cut by a river in a mountainous region is a:

(a) delta (b) loess plain (c) gorge (d) barchan

Ans: (c) River erosion in the upper course.

20. The preparation of electoral rolls is governed by the Representation of the People Act of:

(a) 1950 (b) 1985 (c) 2005 (d) 1935

Ans: (a) RPA 1950 also deals with delimitation and voter qualifications; RPA 1951 deals with conduct of elections.

SECTION B — Very Short Answer Type — 4 questions · 8 marks

Each question carries 2 marks. Answer in about 40 words. (4 × 2 = 8)

21. What is meant by ‘market demand’? How is it obtained from individual demand?

Market demand = total quantity of a good demanded by all buyers at each price (1). Obtained by adding the individual demands at each price (1).

22. Name the sequence of landforms produced by wave erosion on a headland, from the first crack to the final remains.

Crack → sea cave → sea arch → sea stack → stump (2 marks; ½ for each correct pair of stages).

OR

What is a GI tag? Give one example of a GI-tagged forest product from India.

Geographical Indication – a label showing a product originates from a specific place and its quality is linked to it (1). Example: Ramban Sulai Honey (J&K) / Nilgiri Tea (1).

23. A television costs ₹24,000. A family buys it on twelve monthly EMIs of ₹2,200 each. How much extra do they pay? What does the extra amount represent?

Total paid = 12 × 2,200 = ₹26,400; extra = ₹2,400 (1). It represents interest charged by the lender (1).

24. State any two duties of a king in ancient India.

Any two (1 each): protect subjects, deliver justice, take counsel of ministers/assemblies, collect and use revenue for welfare, uphold dharma.

SECTION C — Short Answer Type — 5 questions · 15 marks

Each question carries 3 marks. Answer in about 60 words. (5 × 3 = 15)

25. What role do local bodies like Gram Panchayats play in deepening democracy? Give three points.

> Bring decision-making close to people (1); allow participation of villagers and women through reservation (1); resolve local needs like water, roads, sanitation (1).

26. India retained some colonial institutions after 1947. Explain how its leaders adapted them to Indian values. Give three examples.

> India preserved knowledge of pre-colonial traditions (1); Constitution framed in the spirit of Indian values (1); mottos adopted: Satyameva Jayate (Muṇḍaka Upaniṣhad), 'Yato Dharmastato Jayaḥ' (Mahābhārata) for the Supreme Court; Sengol (1).

27. Describe the contribution of Egypt to world civilisation in three points.

> Nile valley farming and flood cycle (1); hieroglyphs on papyrus and monuments (1); pyramids, administration, trade and early science (1).

OR

Explain how the Neolithic revolution changed human life. Give three points.

> Shift from hunting to farming and herding (1); settled villages and surplus (1); pottery, new tools, population growth and beginning of trade (1).

28. How did Indian kingdoms resist the Delhi Sultanate? Mention three kingdoms and how their resistance mattered.

> Yādavas of Devagiri, Kākatīyas of Warangal, Hoysālas, Rajput dynasties – any three named (1.5); repeatedly resisted and checked the Sultanate's expansion; resistance was political and for preserving socio-cultural continuity (1.5).

29. What are the main weaknesses of a planned economy? Explain with two examples of how a market economy works differently.

> Weakness: little incentive to innovate, lack of consumer choice, delays (1.5). Market: decisions through prices and demand–supply, private firms respond to consumers' needs (1.5).

SECTION D — Long Answer Type — 4 questions · 20 marks

Each question carries 5 marks. Answer in about 120 words. (4 × 5 = 20)

30. Compare the First-Past-the-Post system and proportional representation. Where is each used in India?

> FPTP – candidate with most votes wins in a constituency (1); used for Lok Sabha and Vidhan Sabha (1). PR with single transferable vote – seats in proportion to votes through preferences (1); used for Rajya Sabha, President, Vice-President, Vidhan Parishad (1); one advantage/limitation of each (1).

OR

Describe the structure and functions of the Election Commission of India. How does it promote inclusion?

> Constitutional body (Articles 324–329) (1); prepares rolls, schedules polls, registers parties, allots symbols (2); supervises model code (0.5); promotes inclusion through EVMs, facilities for disabled and elderly, voter awareness (1.5).

31. Describe the characteristics, location and importance of the tropical rainforest, grassland, desert and tundra biomes.

> Rainforest – hot, wet near Equator; Amazon, Congo basin; gene bank (1.5); grassland – moderate rain; prairies, steppes, savanna (1.25); desert – Sahara/Gobi, Rann of Kutch, adaptations (1.25); tundra – permafrost, mosses/lichens, reindeer (1).

OR

Explain how forest-dwelling communities depend on forests and the challenges they face. State two government measures to support them.

> Dependence: NTFPs like tendu, mahua, honey, bamboo, medicinal plants; cultural rituals; women's role (2). Challenges: restricted access, fires/floods/landslides, human–wildlife conflict, poor access to health/education (1.5). Measures: Forest Rights Act 2006, JFM, PESA, PM JANMAN etc. (1.5).

32. Describe the structure of the atmosphere and explain how weather differs from climate. Name its elements.

> Five layers (1.5); weather vs climate (30 years) (1.5); elements – temperature, humidity, precipitation, pressure, wind (1); examples (1).

OR

What is the ‘greenhouse effect’? Explain how human activities are intensifying climate change and the steps that can reduce it.

> Natural greenhouse effect traps heat (1); burning fossil fuels, deforestation, industry add GHGs (1.5); effects – warming, extreme events, floods like Punjab (1); measures – renewable energy, lower carbon footprint, preparedness (1.5).

33. Explain the four functional areas of a business using the example of a bakery.

> Management and operations – planning, equipment, quality, production schedule (1.25); finance and accounting – fixed/variable costs, profit and loss account (1.25); human resources – hiring and training (1.25); marketing and sales – promotion, pricing, packaging (1.25).

OR

‘A business plan is a dynamic roadmap.’ Explain the components of a business plan for a new startup and state when it may need to be changed.

> Needs/idea, customers, money and costs, location/operations, human resources, pricing and profit, promotion, risks (any five items, 3.5); changes when market, costs or customer preferences change (1.5).

SECTION E — Source-based / Case-based Questions — 3 questions · 12 marks

Each question carries 4 marks (1 + 1 + 2). (3 × 4 = 12)

34. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.*

“The Sindhu–Sarasvatī (Harappan) civilisation had well-planned cities. Streets were laid out in a grid, houses had covered drains, and bricks were of a standard size. Seals with symbols and weights of uniform sizes suggest organised trade. Traders took goods such as beads and cotton to far regions such as Mesopotamia. However, the script has not yet been deciphered, so much about its rulers and beliefs remains unknown.”

(i) Name any one feature of town planning at Harappan sites.

> Grid layout / covered drains / standard bricks.

(ii) What do uniform weights and seals indicate?

> Organised trade and administration.

(iii) Why is our understanding of Harappan society incomplete? Give two reasons.

> Script not deciphered (1); no long records of rulers/beliefs, depend on archaeology (1).

35. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.*

“Bhavisha and Dhruv each save ₹1,000 every year and earn 7% annual returns. Bhavisha begins saving at 25 and Dhruv at 35. At 65, Dhruv has only about 40% as much money as Bhavisha. Meanwhile, a school bag that costs ₹1,000 today will cost about ₹1,060 next year if inflation is 6% per year.”

(i) Name the principle that explains why Bhavisha has more money.

> Compounding.

(ii) What will be the price of the school bag after one year at 6% inflation?

> ₹1,060.

(iii) Explain what inflation does to the purchasing power of money kept at home and how investing helps.

> Same money buys fewer goods (1). Investments can grow faster than inflation, protecting the value (1).

36. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.*
"Elections can be disturbed by false news and attempts to intimidate voters. On the day of a State election, a rumour spread on social media that voting machines were malfunctioning in one district, discouraging many people from going to the polling booths. The Election Commission clarified the matter through press notes and appealed to citizens to vote."

(i) Name the authority that clarified the rumour.

> Election Commission of India.

(ii) What term is used for deliberately spread false information?

> Fake news / misinformation.

(iii) Explain two ways in which citizens can protect elections from misinformation.

> Verify information from official sources before sharing (1); report false posts and vote responsibly (1).

SECTION F — Map-based Question — 1 questions · 5 marks

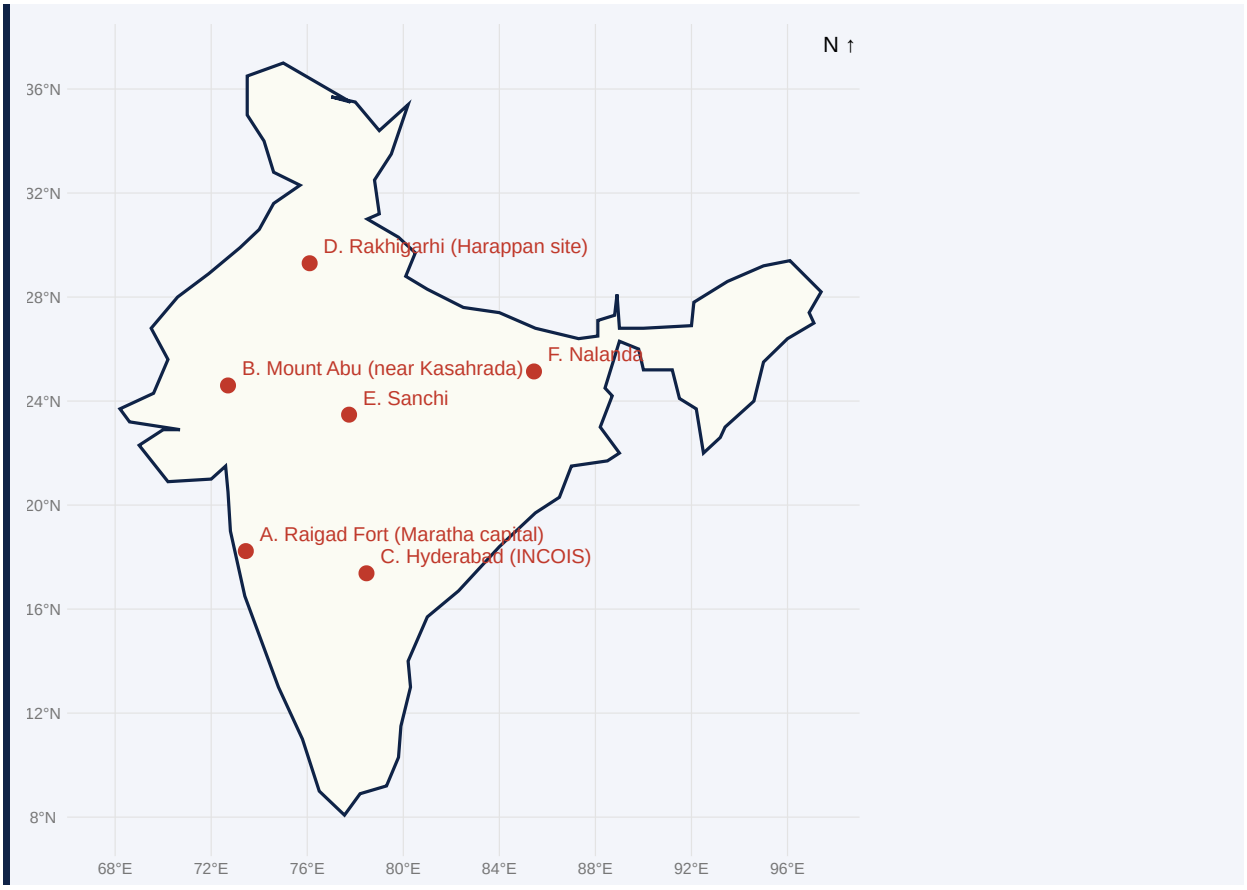
(1 × 5 = 5)

37. On the outline map of India provided, locate and label any **five** of the following (use the given letter/number for each): *Attempt any five. Each item carries 1 mark.*

A. Raigad Fort (Maratha capital)
B. Mount Abu (near Kasahrada)
C. Hyderabad (INCOIS)
D. Rakhigarhi (Harappan site)
E. Sanchi
F. Nalanda

Note — in lieu of Q.37, for visually impaired candidates only (answer any five):
1. Name the State/UT in which Raigad Fort is located.
2. Name the State/UT in which Mount Abu is located.
3. Name the State/UT in which Hyderabad is located.
4. Name the State/UT in which Rakhigarhi is located.
5. Name the State/UT in which Sanchi is located.
6. Name the State/UT in which Nalanda is located.

> 1 mark for each correctly located and labelled item (any five). Correct positions are shown below; answers marked within a tolerance of about 150 km are acceptable.


N ↑
36°N
32°N
28°N
24°N
20°N
16°N
12°N
8°N
68°E
72°E
76°E
80°E
84°E
88°E
92°E
96°E
D. Rakhigarhi (Harappan site)
B. Mount Abu (near Kasahrada)
F. Nalanda
E. Sanchi
A. Raigad Fort (Maratha capital)
C. Hyderabad (INCOIS)